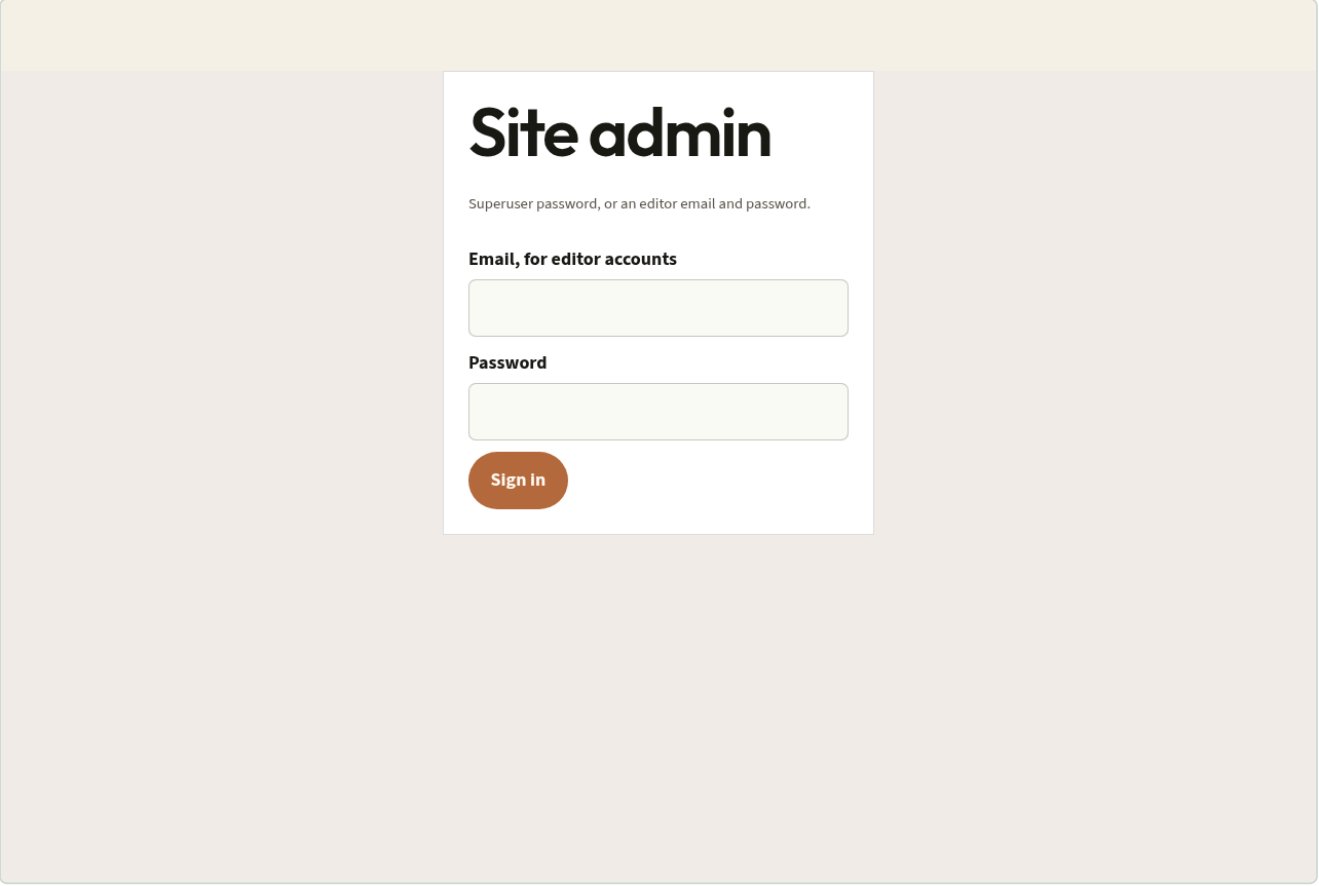
Global Place Partners website: Admin guide

This guide explains how to edit the website through its built-in admin area. Part 1 is for site editors and needs no technical knowledge. Part 2 is for whoever sets up and hosts the site.

Part 1: For site editors

1. Signing in

1. Go to **your-site-address/admin** (for example `https://globalplacepartners.com/admin`).
2. Enter your password and press **Sign in**.
   - **Superuser (main admin):** leave the email box empty and type the main admin password. That password is set by the technical team on the server (see Part 2); it cannot be changed from inside the admin.
   - **Editor:** type the email address and password a superuser created for you in the **access** tab.
3. You stay signed in for 24 hours on that browser. Press **Sign out** (top right) when you finish on a shared computer.



Superuser or editor? Both can edit all content and publish. Only a superuser can create or remove editor accounts, restore an earlier version of the site, see stored contact-form enquiries, and change the enquiry recipient address.

2. The most important idea: draft, Save draft, Publish

There are two copies of the site content: the **draft** (what you are working on) and the **published** version (what visitors see).

The bar at the top of the admin has four buttons:

Button	What it does
Save draft	Saves your changes to the draft. Visitors see nothing yet.
Preview	Opens the site in a new tab showing the **last saved** draft. Press Save draft first, or your latest edits will not show.
Publish	Saves the current draft and makes it live for everyone. A snapshot is kept in **history**.
Sign out	Ends your session.

Things that follow draft-then-Publish: **pages and sections, people, navigation, brand, form**.

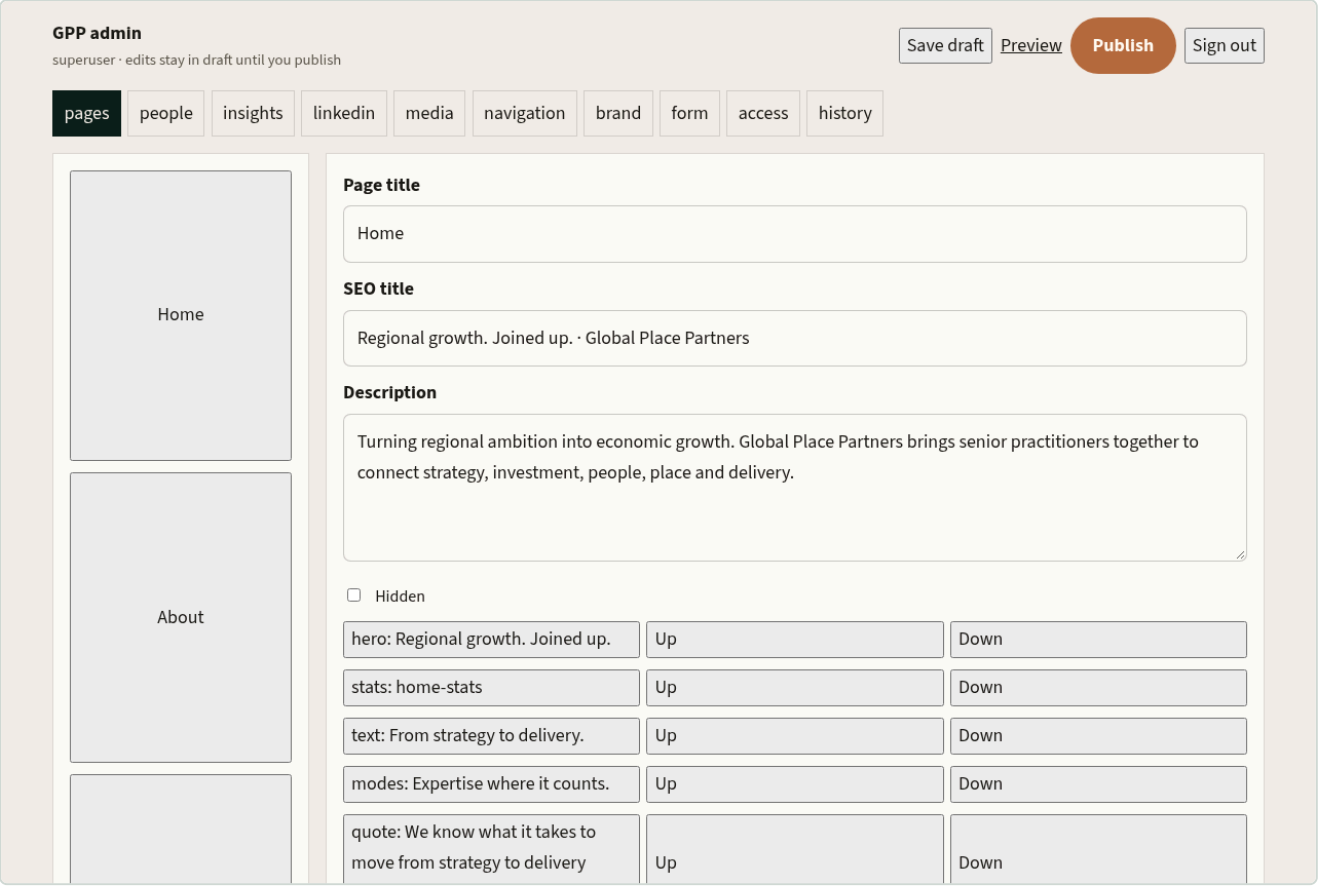
Things that go live **as soon as you save them** (no Publish needed): **insights articles, LinkedIn posts, media library uploads, editor accounts**.

> There is no "unsaved changes" warning. If you close the tab or sign out before pressing Save draft, your edits are lost.

3. The tabs

`pages · people · insights · linkedin · media · navigation · brand · form · access · history`

3.1 pages



- **Left column:** every page. Click one to edit it. At the bottom, type a **New page title** and press **Create page** to make a new page. Its address is made from the title (e.g. "Case studies" becomes `/case-studies`). New pages are not added to the menu automatically; add them in the **navigation** tab.
- **Page title, SEO title, Description:** the title, the text shown in the browser tab and search results, and the search-result summary.
- **Hidden:** hides the whole page from visitors.
- **Delete page:** only shown for pages you created. The built-in pages cannot be deleted (you can hide them).
- **Section list:** the page is made of sections, top to bottom. Click a section to edit it. Use **Up / Down** to move it. Hidden sections show "Hidden:" in front.
- **Add section:** pick a type from the drop-down and press **Add section**. It is added at the bottom; move it with Up/Down.

Section fields

Every section has the same editing panel. Not every field is used by every type (see the table below).

Field	Meaning
Section type	What kind of block it is (see table below).
Eyebrow	The small label above the heading.
Heading	The main heading. Press Enter to start a new line. On some sections, the second and later lines are shown in the copper accent colour; whether that happens is set per section in the code and cannot be changed in the admin.

Field	Meaning
Supporting line	A short line under the heading (used by the hero and side-by-side layouts).
Body	Paragraph text. Leave a blank line between paragraphs.
Image address / image picker	Picture shown with the section. Choose from the media library or paste an address.
Image description	Alt text for screen readers. Always fill in for meaningful images.
Link 1 / Link 2 (label + address)	Buttons. Addresses can be pages on this site (e.g. `/contact`) or full web addresses.
Background	`paper, cream, white, sage, deep, green, pine, teal`.
Spacing	How much space above and below.
Layout	`stack` (one column), `split` (two columns), `split-reverse` (two columns, swapped).
First link style	Whether the first link appears as a solid button.
Items shown as	For **text** sections with items: a list, or **tiles** (the 3 × 2 grid used for the six Growth Model areas).
Show a row of team portraits	For **text** sections: adds the strip of team photos (used on the home page People teaser).
Hide section	Hides it without deleting it.
Items	The repeating entries (title + text, plus extra fields for some types). Add, edit, reorder and remove items here.
Duplicate / Delete	Copy the section just below it, or remove it.

Section types

Type	What it shows	Fields that matter
hero	The big opening banner at the top of a page.	Eyebrow, heading, supporting line, body, image, links.
text	General text block. Can show items as a list or as tiles, and can show the portrait row.	All general fields, items, "Items shown as", portraits.
stats	A row of large figures.	Items: **title** is the big figure, **text** is the label under it.
quote	A pull-quote band with artwork.	Heading is the quote, body is the attribution, image is the artwork (e.g. constellation graphic).
linkedin	Shows the latest LinkedIn posts from the **linkedin** tab.	Eyebrow, heading, body, and how many posts to show.
modes	A list of numbered rows (e.g. ways of working).	Heading, body, items.
diagram	An image with labelled points (Growth Model).	Image, items (each with a group).

Type	What it shows	Fields that matter
diagnostic	The interactive self-check questions.	Items (label, question text), a note, and the result text. In the result, text before the first colon is shown in bold.
people	The full team grid, grouped, with biography pop-ups. Content comes from the **people** tab.	Heading/eyebrow only.
insights	The list of articles from the **insights** tab.	Heading/eyebrow only.
contact	The enquiry form. Labels are edited in the **form** tab.	Heading, body.
cta	A closing call-to-action band with buttons.	Heading, body, links.

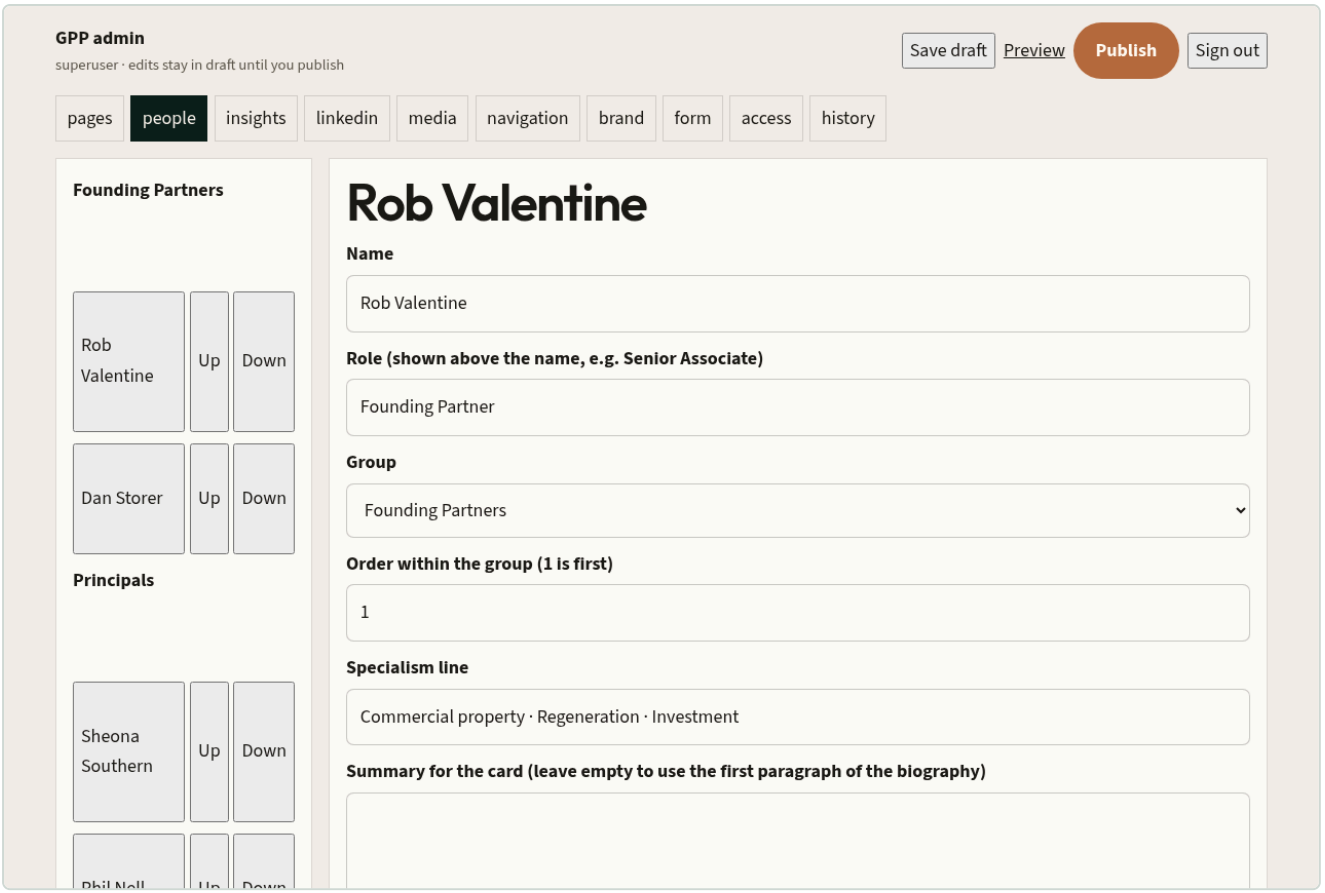
The `[Stat]` placeholder

The home page stats row ships with placeholder figures such as **[Stat]**, because no real numbers were supplied. Any stat whose title starts with `[` is shown in a muted placeholder style so it is obviously not final. To finish it:

1. pages → Home → click the **stats** section.
2. In each item, replace `[Stat]` in **title** with the real figure (e.g. `40+`) and put the description in **text**.
3. Save draft, Preview, then Publish.

If you have no real figures, select the section and tick **Hide section** instead. Do not publish placeholder figures as if they were facts.

3.2 people



The left column lists everyone by group: **Founding Partners**, **Principals**, **Senior Associates**.

Add someone: press **Add employee**, then fill in:

- **Name** and **Role** (shown above the name, e.g. "Senior Associate").
- **Group**: which heading they appear under on the People page.
- **Order within the group**: 1 is first. You can also use the **Up / Down** buttons in the list.
- **Specialism line**: short line under the name, e.g. "Commercial property · Regeneration · Investment".
- **Summary for the card**: a few lines on the card. Leave empty to use the first paragraph of the biography. Long summaries are cut off on the card.
- **Full biography**: shown in the pop-up when a visitor clicks the person. Leave a blank line between paragraphs. If this is empty, the card has no "Read full biography" link.
- **LinkedIn URL**: their profile address (must start with `https://`). Shown as a link in the pop-up.
- **Photo**: **Upload a photo** (JPG, PNG, WebP or GIF, up to 8 MB) or paste an address in **Or photo address**. Square, head-and-shoulders photos work best; the site applies the same colour treatment to every portrait so mismatched backgrounds look consistent.
- **Crop horizontal / Crop vertical / Crop zoom**: sliders to position the face in the square frame.
- **Portrait description**: alt text, e.g. "Portrait of Jane Smith".
- **Hide from the site**: keeps the person in the admin but removes them from the site.

Delete someone: select them, press **Delete employee**, confirm. This removes them from the draft; they disappear from the site when you **Publish**.

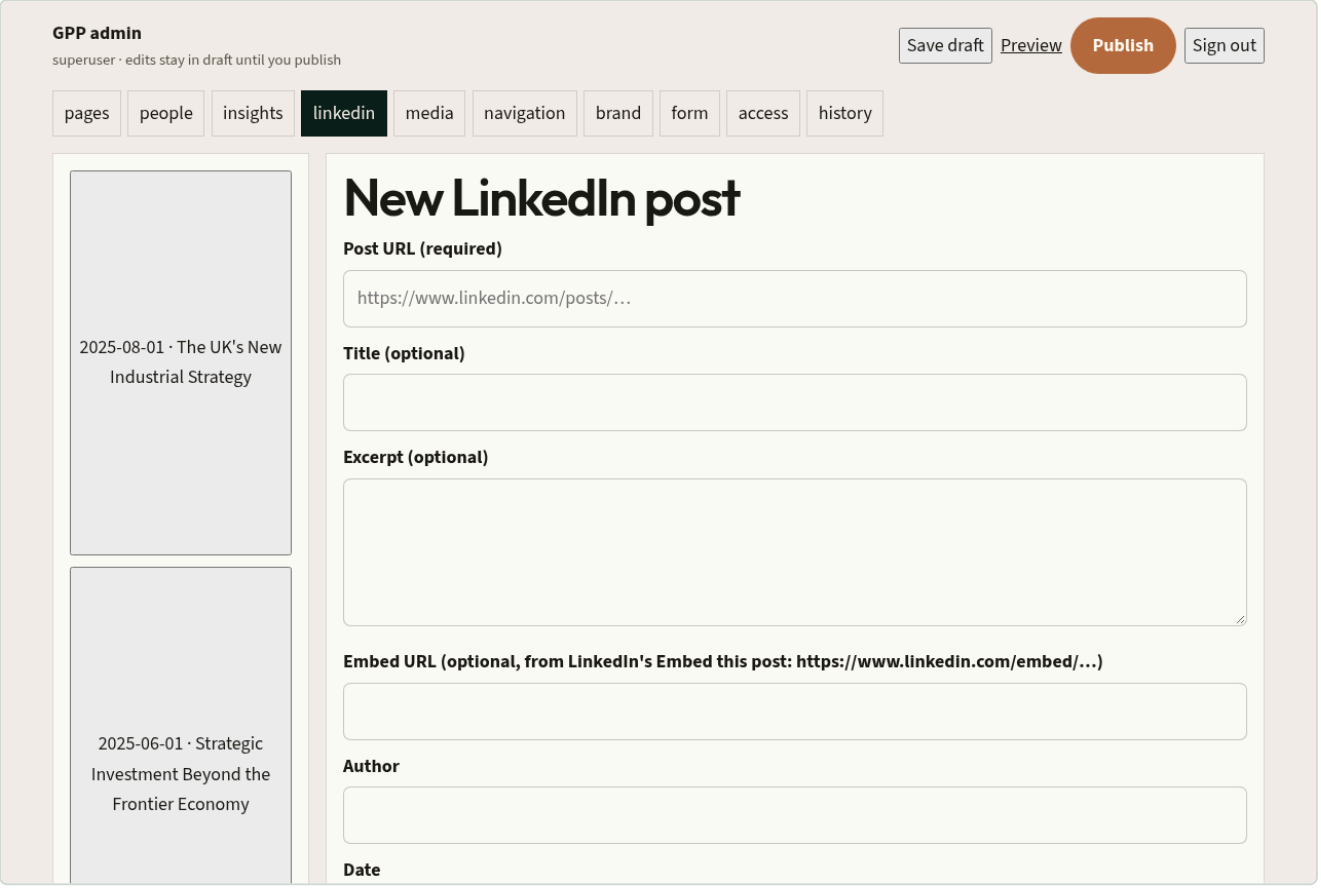
Remember: people changes need **Save draft** and **Publish**. (An uploaded photo is stored straight away, but it is only attached to the person once you save.)

3.3 insights

Articles for the Insights page. Press **New article**, fill in title, summary, body (for an article hosted on this site) or **External URL** (to link to an article elsewhere), slug (the page address), source, category, author, featured image, SEO title and description.

- **Status:** `draft` (not visible), `scheduled` (appears automatically after the **Publish at** date/time), `published` (visible).
- **Featured article:** highlights it on the Insights page.
- **Create article / Save article** saves it and it takes effect **immediately** (according to its status). **Delete article** removes it.

3.4 linkedin



LinkedIn posts appear in any **linkedin** section (the home page band and the Insights page), newest date first.

1. Press **Add LinkedIn post**.
2. **Post URL (required):** open the post on LinkedIn and copy the address from the browser bar (it must be a `linkedin.com` address).
3. **Embed URL (optional):** shows the real post inside the site.
    - On LinkedIn, open the post, click the ⋯ (three dots) menu and choose **Embed this post**.
    - LinkedIn shows a piece of code like `<iframe src="https://www.linkedin.com/embed/feed/update/urn:li:share:123..." ...>`.
    - Copy **only the address inside the quotes after `src=`**, starting `https://www.linkedin.com/embed/`, and paste it here. Pasting the whole code will not

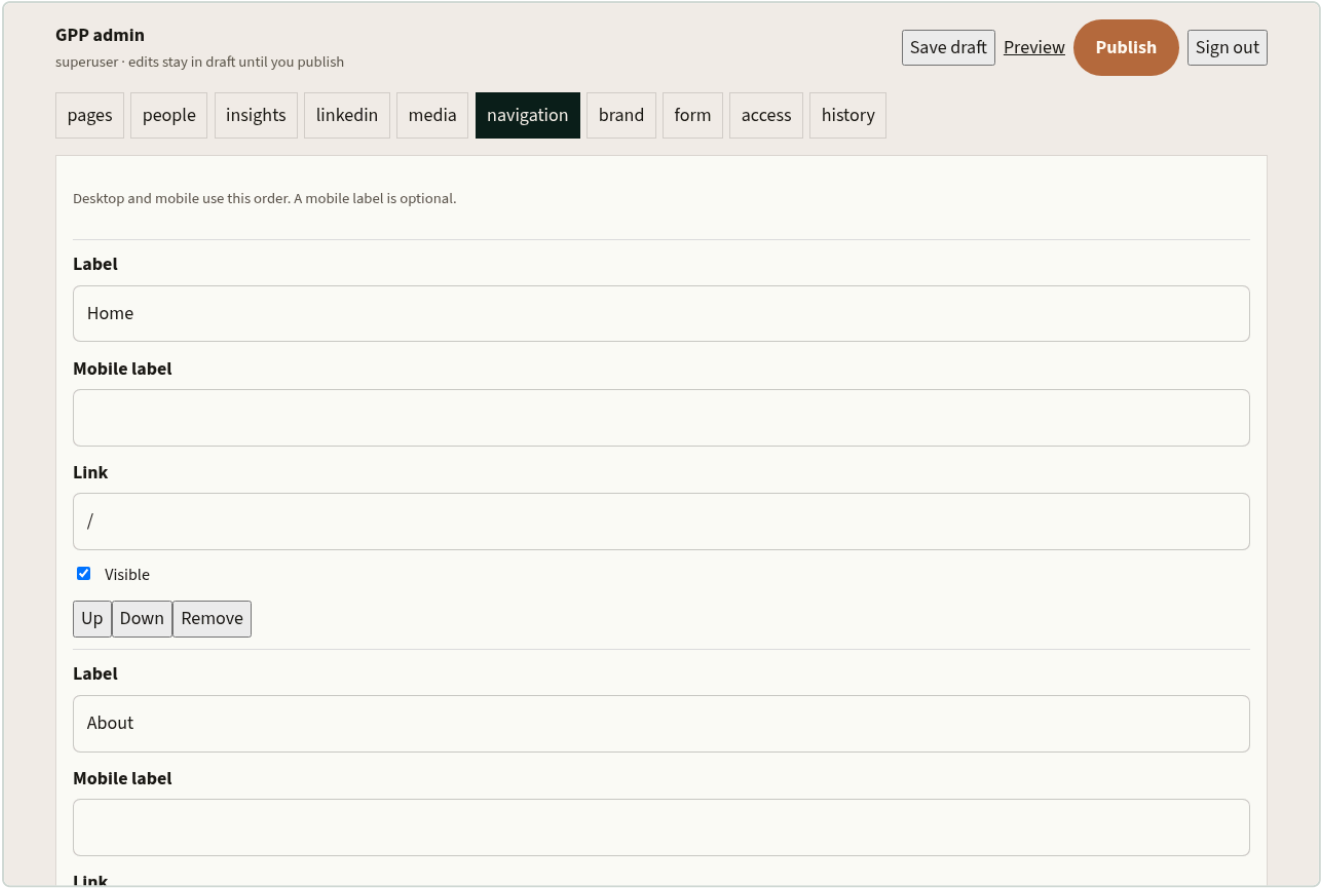
work; only `linkedin.com/embed/` addresses are accepted.
    - "Embed this post" is only offered for public posts.
4. If you don't use an embed, fill in **Title**, **Excerpt** and optionally **Image address** (or upload an image) so the site shows a card linking to LinkedIn.
5. **Date** (used for ordering), **Author**.
6. Press save. **The post goes live immediately**, no Publish needed. Tick **Hide from the site** to take it down without deleting it, or **Delete post** to remove it permanently.

3.5 media

The image library. Type a **Description for the next upload**, then choose a file under **Upload image** (JPG, PNG, WebP, GIF, max 8 MB). It uploads straight away and becomes available in every image picker. For existing images you can change the alt text or **Replace file** and press **Update image**. Replacing a file updates it everywhere it is used.

Tip: resize photos to about 800–1600 px wide before uploading; it keeps the site fast.

3.6 navigation



The main menu. For each entry: **Label**, **Mobile label**, **Link** and **Visible**. Use Up/Down, **Remove** and **Add link**. Save draft and Publish.

3.7 brand

Site-wide settings: site name, colours, heading and body fonts, logo address and description, public email, footer line, legal footer text, legal links (**Add legal link**) and the canonical site address. Superusers also

see the **enquiry recipient** email. Save draft and Publish.

3.8 form

The labels and messages of the contact form. Save draft and Publish.

3.9 access (superuser only)

Create editor accounts (name, email, password of at least 8 characters) and remove them. Changes take effect immediately. The main superuser password is not managed here (see Part 2).

3.10 history

- **Revisions:** every Publish creates a snapshot (the last 40 are kept). A superuser can press **Restore** to bring one back. **Restore makes that version live immediately** and replaces the current draft too.
- **Enquiries (superuser only):** contact-form submissions stored by the site, with whether the email was delivered.

4. Images: quick rules

- Upload through the media tab, people tab or any image picker. All end up in the media library.
- Always add a description (alt text).
- Images that came with the site live at `/images/...` addresses; they can be used but only replaced by a developer. To change one, upload a new image and pick it instead.

5. Troubleshooting

Problem	What to do
"Invalid password" / can't sign in	Superuser: leave the email empty. Editors: check the email. If the superuser password is lost, the technical team resets `ADMIN_PASSWORD` (Part 2).
Signed out unexpectedly	Sessions last 24 hours; also, changing `SESSION_SECRET` on the server signs everyone out. Sign in again. Unsaved changes are lost.
My changes don't show in Preview	Press **Save draft** first, then reload the Preview tab.
My changes don't show on the live site	Press **Publish**. Then hard-refresh the page (Ctrl/Cmd + Shift + R).
A new person doesn't appear	Check they aren't ticked "Hide from the site", are in the right group, and that you published.
LinkedIn post shows a card instead of the real post	The embed URL is empty or wasn't accepted. Paste only the `https://www.linkedin.com/embed/...` address.
Embedded post is blank	The post may have been deleted or made private on LinkedIn. Remove the embed URL and use title/excerpt instead.

Problem	What to do
Upload fails	Use JPG/PNG/WebP/GIF under 8 MB.
Edits disappear after a while (live site)	The site isn't connected to its database. Tell the technical team (Part 2, "Storage").
I published a mistake	A superuser can **Restore** an earlier revision in history, or fix it and publish again.

Part 2: Technical setup

Architecture

- React + Vite single-page app (`src/`), served by Vercel as static files.
- Express API (`server/app.js`, exposed on Vercel via `api/index.mjs`) for content, admin and the contact form.
- Content store (`server/store.js`): **Postgres** when `DATABASE_URL` is set, otherwise a JSON file (`data/cms.json`, or `/tmp/gpp-data` on Vercel). Initial content comes from `server/seed.js` the first time the store is empty.

Environment variables

Variable	Required	Purpose
`SESSION_SECRET`	**Yes**	Long random string used to sign admin session cookies. The admin will not work without it. Changing it signs everyone out.
`ADMIN_PASSWORD`	**Yes**	The superuser password (sign in with empty email). Change it here to reset it.
`DATABASE_URL`	**Yes in production**	Postgres connection string. Without it, edits on Vercel are not saved permanently.
`DATABASE_SSL`	No	`true` / `false` to force SSL on/off. SSL is used automatically on Vercel or with `sslmode=require`; `sslmode=disable` turns it off.
`RESEND_API_KEY`, `RESEND_FROM_EMAIL`	No	Send contact-form emails via Resend. Without them, enquiries are only stored (history tab).
`CONTACT_TO_EMAILS`	No	Comma-separated recipients; overrides the recipient set in brand.
`TURNSTILE_SITE_KEY`, `TURNSTILE_SECRET_KEY`	Production	Cloudflare Turnstile spam check on the form. Defaults are Cloudflare's always-pass test keys, which provide no protection.

Admin passwords for editors are stored hashed (scrypt). Session cookies are HTTP-only, `SameSite=Lax`, `Secure` in production, and expire after 24 hours. The contact form is limited to 5 submissions per hour per IP.

Deploying on Vercel

1. Import the GitHub repo `rrs77/dangpprevised-v2` into Vercel. Build settings come from `vercel.json` (`npm run build`, output `dist`, `/api/*` routed to the Express app, everything else to the SPA).

2. Create a Postgres database (e.g. Vercel Marketplace → Neon, or any hosted Postgres) and copy its connection string.
3. In Project → Settings → Environment Variables add `SESSION_SECRET`, `ADMIN_PASSWORD`, `DATABASE_URL` and, as needed, the Resend and Turnstile variables. Redeploy.
4. Visit `/admin`, sign in and publish once to confirm saving works.

Postgres

No manual SQL is needed. On first start the app creates its tables (`cms_state` for content, `cms_media` for uploaded images) and fills them from `server/seed.js` if empty.

Important: once the database contains content, **changes to `server/seed.js` are not applied** to it. Seed changes only affect a brand-new database. Edit live content in the admin. If you point v2 at a database already used by an older version of the site, it will show that older content (the new home sections, stats, quote, LinkedIn band etc. won't appear). Use a fresh database for v2, or add the sections in the admin.

If the database can't be reached at start-up, the app logs `Postgres unavailable; serving the built-in site content.` and serves the seed content; edits in that state are not saved to the database.

Storage and uploads

- With Postgres, uploaded images are stored **in the database** (`cms_media`) and served from `/api/media/<id>`, so they persist across deploys. Nothing else is required.
- Without `DATABASE_URL` on Vercel, content and uploads go to `/tmp`, which is temporary and per-instance: edits will vanish. Always set `DATABASE_URL` in production.
- Locally without Postgres, content is in `data/cms.json` and uploads in the `data/` folder. Delete `data/cms.json` to reset to the seed.

Local development

`server/dev.js` does not read a `.env` file, so pass variables in the shell:

```
 npm install
SESSION_SECRET=dev-secret ADMIN_PASSWORD=dev npm run dev
#   API on http://127.0.0.1:3001, site + admin on http://127.0.0.1:5173

npm run build                     # production build into dist/
SESSION_SECRET=dev-secret ADMIN_PASSWORD=dev npm start
#   serves dist/ and the API together on http://127.0.0.1:3001
```

Add `DATABASE_URL=postgres://...` to test against Postgres.

Smoke test

With the server running (e.g. `npm start` as above), in another terminal:

```
ADMIN_PASSWORD=dev npm run smoke          # BASE defaults to http://127.0.0.1:3001
```

It checks public pages and the API, signs in, edits and publishes a draft (then restores the original text), adds a person with a photo, reorders and deletes them, creates/edits/hides/deletes a LinkedIn post, and tests the contact form. Run it against a local or staging copy, not the live site: it publishes changes while it runs.